Woman 7:
Nonsense, Dorothea, you know your tooth is as black as the kitchen range. You're only trying to get out of it.

(The Little Girl breaks into a howl.)

Man 2:
I can't stand howling children. I'm off.
(Standing)

Man 3:
And I can't stand them either. I'm coming with you.
(Standing)

(Exit Man 2 and Man 3.)

Woman 7:
Now, see what you've done, Dorothea, you've chased those men away.

Little Girl: They're lucky.

(The Little Girl howls again. The Nurse enters, this time with a hacksaw.)

Woman 1:
Oh, Joe! Joe! He'll never stand it. The sound of sawing always did put his teeth on edge.

Man 7:
This time the saw will be on the edge of his teeth.

Woman 2: Oh, you horrible Man!

Man 7: Can't I even make a joke?

Man 8: We need something to cheer us up.

Woman 4:
Surely it's against the law for a dentist to use a saw like that.

(The sound of violent sawing is heard from the surgery. Man 4 groans loudly.)

Woman 1: Oh no, Joe! No, Joe!

(Woman 1 makes a dash for the door but is prevented from opening it by Woman 2 and Woman 6.)

Woman 3:
You really must control yourself.

Woman 2:
There, there, dear. I'm sure it's not as bad as it sounds.

(They place Woman 1 back in her seat.)

Woman 1:
I'm not waiting to find out. I've heard enough.

Woman 3:
I prefer to keep my toothache.

Woman 4:
So do I. Me too. Those pliers would never fit my mouth, anyway. It's better than being murdered, anyway.
(Standing)

(Exit Woman 3, Woman 4 and Woman 6.)

Man 7:
Just watch them go, cowards every one of them.

Woman 2:
It's all very well you talking this way. You don't seem to have any nerves at all.

Man 7:
This is nothing to some of the things I've heard of. I could tell you things that would make your hair stand on end. There was once...

Woman 2:
I'm sure we don't want to hear it. My hair is standing on end already.

(The sawing is heard again, even louder and harsher this time. Woman 1 wails and Man 4 groans.)

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